AlifUp — teacher review sheet

Thank you for checking this. AlifUp is a free app that teaches adult beginners to read the Quran. Below is **every piece of teaching content** in the app — letter names, sounds, explanations, rules and recordings — exactly as learners see it. Please tick **OK** or write a correction. The Quran text itself (Tanzil Uthmani, unchanged) and the recitation (Mishary Alafasy) are not in question here.

> How sounds are written: one Latin letter (or pair) per Arabic letter — **ḥ ṣ ḍ ṭ ẓ** for the heavy letters, ʿ for ʿayn, **th dh kh gh sh** as in the names; long vowels **ā ī ū**. The hints are deliberately short and in plain English for adult beginners.

1. The letters

Name and sound as shown; the hint appears on the letter's card and in feedback. The recording says the letter's **name** — please listen to the files (or in the app: tap the letter). Special attention: the recordings of **ط / ث**, **ط / ت** and **ه / ح** were matched to letters by analysing the sound, not by ear — please confirm each is the right letter.

#	Letter	Shapes (alone · start · middle · end)	Name	Sound	Hint shown to learners	Recording	Check
1	ا	ا ا	**Alif**	a	Carries a long "aa" sound, or a hamza	files/letters/alif.mp3	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
2	ب	ب بـ ـبـ ـب	**Ba**	b	"b" as in book — one dot below	files/letters/ba.mp3	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
3	ت	ت تـ ـتـ ـت	**Ta**	t	"t" as in tea — two dots above	files/letters/ta.mp3	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
4	ث	ث ثـ ـثـ ـث	**Tha**	th	"th" as in think — three dots above	files/letters/tha.mp3	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
5	ج	ج جـ ـجـ ـج	**Jim**	j	"j" as in jam — one dot inside	files/letters/jim.mp3	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
6	ح	ح حـ ـحـ ـح	**Ḥa**	ḥ	A breathy "h" from the middle of the throat	files/letters/haa.mp3	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
7	خ	خ خـ ـخـ ـخ	**Kha**	kh	"kh" as in Scottish loch — one dot above	files/letters/kha.mp3	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
8	د	د ـد	**Dal**	d	"d" as in door	files/letters/dal.mp3	☐ OK ☐ Fix:

9	ذ	ذ ـذ	**Dhal**	dh	"th" as in this — one dot above	files/letters/dhal.mp3	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
10	ر	ر ـر	**Ra**	r	A lightly rolled "r"	files/letters/ra.mp3	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
11	ز	ز ـز	**Zay**	z	"z" as in zoo — one dot above	files/letters/zay.mp3	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
12	س	س سـ ـسـ ـس	**Sin**	s	"s" as in sun — three teeth	files/letters/sin.mp3	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
13	ش	ش شـ ـشـ ـش	**Shin**	sh	"sh" as in shoe — three dots above	files/letters/shin.mp3	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
14	ص	ص صـ ـصـ ـص	**Ṣad**	ṣ	A heavy, full-mouthed "s"	files/letters/sad.mp3	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
15	ض	ض ضـ ـضـ ـض	**Ḍad**	ḍ	A heavy "d" — Ṣad with a dot	files/letters/dad.mp3	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
16	ط	ط طـ ـطـ ـط	**Ṭa**	ṭ	A heavy, full-mouthed "t"	files/letters/taa.mp3	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
17	ظ	ظ ظـ ـظـ ـظ	**Ẓa**	ẓ	A heavy "th" as in this — Ṭa with a dot	files/letters/zaa.mp3	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
18	ع	ع عـ ـعـ ـع	**ʿAyn**	ʿ	A deep sound squeezed from the throat	files/letters/ayn.mp3	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
19	غ	غ غـ ـغـ ـغ	**Ghayn**	gh	A gargled "gh", like a French r	files/letters/ghayn.mp3	☐ OK ☐ Fix:

20	ف	ف ـفـ ـفـ ف	**Fa**	f	"f" as in fish — one dot above	files/letters/fa.mp3	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
21	ق	ق ـقـ ـقـ ق	**Qaf**	q	A deep "k" from the back of the throat	files/letters/qaf.mp3	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
22	ك	ك ـكـ ـكـ ك	**Kaf**	k	"k" as in kite	files/letters/kaf.mp3	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
23	ل	ل ـلـ ـلـ ل	**Lam**	l	"l" as in lamp	files/letters/lam.mp3	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
24	م	م ـمـ ـمـ م	**Mim**	m	"m" as in moon	files/letters/mim.mp3	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
25	ن	ن ـنـ ـنـ ن	**Nun**	n	"n" as in noon — one dot above	files/letters/nun.mp3	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
26	ه	ه ـهـ ـهـ ه	**Ha**	h	A light "h" as in hat	files/letters/ha.mp3	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
27	و	و ـو	**Waw**	w	"w" as in wall, or a long "oo"	files/letters/waw.mp3	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
28	ي	ي ـيـ ـيـ ي	**Ya**	y	"y" as in yes, or a long "ee"	files/letters/ya.mp3	☐ OK ☐ Fix:

2. Short vowels

Name	Example	Explanation	Check
Fatḥa	بَ = ba	A small stroke above the letter: a short "a"	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
Kasra	بِ = bi	A small stroke below the letter: a short "i"	☐ OK ☐ Fix:

Ḍamma	ُ بُ = bu	A small waw above the letter: a short "u"	☐ OK ☐ Fix:

3. Reading rules

Practice syllables are put together from letters and marks, as in a Qāʿida (e.g. مَكْ "mak", رَبَّ "rabba", بًا "ban", بَا "bā"). Wāw and yā are never given sukūn after a matching vowel (that would be a long vowel), and ʿayn is left out of two-syllable practice words.

Rule	Explanation shown to learners	Check
Sukūn	A small circle above a letter: the letter has no vowel of its own. It closes the syllable before it: m-a-k is read "mak".	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
Shadda	A small "w" above a letter: say the letter twice — hold it, then add its vowel: r-a-bb-a is read "rabba".	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
Tanwīn	A doubled vowel mark adds an "n" sound: "an", "in", "un". It comes at the end of a word; the "an" form is usually followed by an alif, which is not read.	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
Long vowels	Alif after fatḥa, yā after kasra and wāw after ḍamma stretch the vowel to two beats: "bā", "bī", "bū". In the Quran a small alif above a letter does the same.	☐ OK ☐ Fix:

4. Tajweed colours in the reader

Colours come from an open dataset (quran-tajweed, CC BY 4.0). Please check the one-line explanations, and spot-check a few surahs in the app for wrongly coloured letters.

Group	Explanation shown to learners	Check
Madd	Stretch the vowel longer than usual	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
Ghunnah	A nasal sound held for two counts	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
Ikhfa	Nun or tanwin hidden, said softly through the nose	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
Idghaam	A letter merged into the next one	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
Iqlab	Nun or tanwin turned into a meem sound	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
Qalqalah	A light echo on ق ط ب ج د with sukun	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
Silent	Written but not pronounced	☐ OK ☐ Fix:

5. Opening letters (ḥurūf muqaṭṭaʿāt) — what is heard

Ayah	Description shown	Check
2:1	Alif · Lām · Mīm	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
10:1	Alif · Lām · Rā, then the rest of the ayah	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
19:1	Kāf · Hā · Yā · ʿAyn · Ṣād	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
20:1	Ṭā · Hā	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
36:1	Yā · Sīn	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
38:1	Ṣād, then the rest of the ayah	☐ OK ☐ Fix:

40:1	Ḥā · Mīm	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
42:2	ʿAyn · Sīn · Qāf	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
50:1	Qāf, then the rest of the ayah	☐ OK ☐ Fix:
68:1	Nūn, then the rest of the ayah	☐ OK ☐ Fix:

6. Voice questions in exams

The learner records themselves and the app compares the recording with the reciter's, on the device. It is told:

> Your voice is compared with the reciter's recording on this device and never uploaded. It checks how alike they sound, not tajweed.

Is this wording clear enough that nobody takes it as approval of their recitation?	☐ OK ☐ Fix:

7. Translation

The reader can show the Saheeh International English translation (from Tanzil). It is shown as is, ayah by ayah, and is not part of the lessons.

8. Anything else

Missing, misleading, or worth adding — anything is welcome.

Reviewed by (name)	Date

Appendix: recording notes

```
# Letter recordings

`<letter>.mp3` (the 28 letter names) come from
https://github.com/razunatmohammed88-cyber/arabic-alphabet-audio
(commit 6848aac, "Add complete Arabic alphabet audio set", 2025), MIT License,
Copyright (c) 2025 razunatmohammed88-cyber — full text in `licenses/letter-audio-MIT.txt`.

Converted with `tools/letter-audio/make_clips.py one` (silence trimmed, loudness
normalised, mono 64 kbps MP3). The source files `taa`/`taa'`, `thaa`/`thaa'` and
`haa`/`haa'` were told apart by their sound (emphatic letters lower the vowel's second
formant; ح has a longer breathy onset than ه): taa → ت, taa' → ط, thaa → ث,
thaa' → ظ, haa → ح, haa' → ه.

The syllables (`<letter>_a/_i/_u.mp3`: ba, bi, bu …) are not recorded yet.
```